

# Word family: \*\*family / families / familial\*\*

\*\*Base word:\*\* family

\*\*Plural:\*\* families

\*\*Related form:\*\* familial

\*\*Useful compounds / extensions:\*\* family member, family life, family tree, family name, family background, family business, family home

\*\*Part of speech:\*\* mainly noun ( 名詞 ) / adjective-like modifier ( 名詞作修飾語 ) / adjective

\*\*familial\*\*

Your sentence:

> “She is widely respected in my \*\*family\*\* and even in the neighbourhood.”

## Meaning in this passage

Here, \*\*family\*\* means \*\*the group of people related to you by birth, marriage, or another close kinship relationship\*\*.

In your sentence, the grandmother is respected by the speaker's relatives as a group.

\*\*繁體中文\*\*： \*\*與自己有血緣、婚姻或親屬關係的一群人；家人 / 家庭成員\*\*

\*\*中文翻譯\*\*：

> “She is widely respected in my family and even in the neighbourhood.”

「她在我的\*\*家人 / 家族\*\*中，甚至在鄰里之間，都廣受尊重。」

Here:

\*\*my family = 與我有親屬關係的家人 / 家族成員\*\*

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# 1. \*\*family = relatives as a group ( 家人 / 家族 ) — 家人；家族\*\*

This is the exact sense in your passage.

### Practice 1 — Original

> “She is widely respected in my \*\*family\*\*.”

「她在我的\*\*家人 / 家族\*\*中廣受尊重。」

### Practice 2

> “Most of my **family** lives nearby.”

「我的大部分**家人**都住在附近。」

#### ### Practice 3

> “Her **family** supported her during the difficult period.”

「她的**家人**在那段艱難時期支持她。」

**family** = 與某人有親屬關係的一群人，作為一個整體來看

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# 2. **family** = parents and children living/considered together ( 家庭 ) — 家庭；一家人

Here, the focus is more on the household or immediate family unit.

#### ### Practice 4

> “They are a **family** of five.”

「他們是**一家五口**。」

#### ### Practice 5

> “She grew up in a large **family**.”

「她在一個大家庭中長大。」

**family** = 由父母、子女及其他親近家屬組成的家庭單位

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# 3. **family** = someone's children ( 子女 ) — 孩子；子女

A common meaning, especially in expressions like **start a family**.

#### ### Practice 6

> “They want to start a **family**.”

「他們想要**生兒育女 / 建立自己的家庭**。」

#### ### Practice 7

> “She decided to wait before having a **family**.”

「她決定遲一點才**生孩子 / 建立家庭**。」

**family** = 某人的子女，尤其在談生育或建立家庭時

This does not simply mean all relatives.

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# 4. **family** = line of descent / ancestry ( 家族 / 世系 ) — 家族；血統

### Practice 8

> “The house has been in the **family** for generations.”

「這間房子已經在這個**家族**中傳了好幾代。」

### Practice 9

> “There is a history of the condition in her **family**.”

「她的**家族**中有這種情況的病史。」

**family** = 從祖先到後代延續下來的家族世系或血統

This sense is especially common with:

- \* family history
- \* family tradition
- \* family name
- \* run in the family

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# 5. **family** = group of related people across generations ( 家族成員 ) — 家族；親族

Closely related to #4, but the focus is on the broader kinship group.

### Practice 10

> “The whole **family** gathered for the celebration.”

「整個**家族**都聚在一起慶祝。」

### ### Practice 11

> “She is the oldest member of the **family**.”

「她是這個**家族**中年紀最大的成員。」

**family** = 包括不同世代親屬在內的較大家族群體

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# 6. **family** = group of things with shared characteristics ( 同一類 / 族 ) — 類 ; 族 ; 系列

A major figurative and technical meaning.

### ### Practice 12

> “These languages belong to the same language **family**.”

「這些語言屬於同一個語言**語系**。」

### ### Practice 13

> “This drug belongs to a **family** of related medicines.”

「這種藥屬於同一**類**相關藥物。」

**family** = 因來源、結構、特徵或功能相近而被歸在一起的一組事物

This is common in:

- \* linguistics
- \* biology
- \* chemistry
- \* technology
- \* product classification

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# 7. **family** — biology/taxonomy ( 科 / 家族 ) — 科 ; 科別

A specialized scientific use.

### ### Practice 14

> “Cats belong to the **family** Felidae.”

「貓科動物屬於貓\*\*科\*\*。」

#### ### Practice 15

> “The plant belongs to the rose \*\*family\*\*.”

「這種植物屬於薔薇\*\*科\*\*。」

\*\*family = 生物分類中位於 order 與 genus 之間的一個分類層級\*\*

This is a genuine technical meaning and useful for educated learners.

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# 8. \*\*family = group of related products/things ( 產品系列 ) — 系列 ; 同類產品\*\*

#### ### Practice 16

> “The company launched a new \*\*family\*\* of products.”

「公司推出了一個新的產品\*\*系列\*\*。」

#### ### Practice 17

> “These devices belong to the same product \*\*family\*\*.”

「這些裝置屬於同一產品\*\*系列\*\*。」

\*\*family = 因設計、品牌、功能或技術平台相近而組成的一組產品\*\*

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# 9. \*\*family = close-knit group treated like relatives ( 如家人般的群體 ) — 像家人一樣的團體\*\*

A figurative social use.

#### ### Practice 18

> “The team feels like a \*\*family\*\*.”

「這個團隊感覺就像一個\*\*大家庭\*\*。」

#### ### Practice 19

> “After many years together, the staff became a \*\*family\*\*.”

「一起工作多年後，員工之間變得像\*\*家人一樣親密\*\*。」

**\*\*family = 雖然沒有血緣關係，但彼此關係非常親密、互相支持的一群人\*\***

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# 10. **\*\*family = organized criminal group ( 犯罪家族 ) — 家族；幫派家族\*\***

A specialized but well-known meaning.

### Practice 20

> “The novel is about a powerful crime **\*\*family\*\***.”

「這本小說講述一個勢力強大的犯罪**\*\*家族\*\***。」

### Practice 21

> “Several rival **\*\*families\*\*** controlled the area.”

「幾個互相競爭的犯罪**\*\*家族\*\***控制了該地區。」

**\*\*family = 以親屬或緊密組織關係構成的犯罪集團\*\***

This is strongly context-dependent.

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# 11. **\*\*family member — 家庭 / 家族成員\*\***

A key compound.

### Practice 22

> “Every **\*\*family member\*\*** was invited.”

「每位**\*\*家庭成員 / 家人\*\***都獲邀參加。」

### Practice 23

> “She is the oldest **\*\*family member\*\***.”

「她是年紀最大的**\*\*家族成員\*\***。」

**\*\*family member = 屬於某個家庭 / 家族的其中一名親屬\*\***

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## # 12. \*\*family life — 家庭生活\*\*

### ### Practice 24

> “She values her \*\*family life\*\*.”

「她很重視自己的\*\*家庭生活\*\*。」

### ### Practice 25

> “The job made it difficult to balance work and \*\*family life\*\*.”

「這份工作令她很難平衡工作與\*\*家庭生活\*\*。」

**\*\*family life = 與家人共同生活、相處和承擔家庭角色的生活部分\*\***

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## # 13. \*\*family tree — 家譜；家族關係圖\*\*

### ### Practice 26

> “She drew a \*\*family tree\*\* for the school project.”

「她為學校作業畫了一個\*\*家譜 / 家族樹\*\*。」

### ### Practice 27

> “The website helped him build his \*\*family tree\*\*.”

「那個網站幫助他整理自己的\*\*家譜\*\*。」

**\*\*family tree = 用圖表顯示家族成員之間血緣 / 婚姻關係的結構\*\***

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## # 14. \*\*family name — 姓氏 / 家族姓氏\*\*

### ### Practice 28

> “The business still carries the \*\*family name\*\*.”

「這家公司仍然沿用\*\*家族姓氏\*\*。」

### ### Practice 29

> “Her **family name** is Chan.”

「她的**姓氏**是 Chan。」

**family name** = 由家族成員共同使用並傳承的姓氏

In many cultures, this corresponds to:

> surname / last name

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# 15. **family background** — 家庭背景

### ### Practice 30

> “People come from different **family backgrounds**.”

「人們來自不同的**家庭背景**。」

### ### Practice 31

> “Her **family background** influenced her values.”

「她的**家庭背景**影響了她的價值觀。」

**family background** = 一個人的家庭環境、社會情況、成長經歷及家族背景

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# 16. **family home** — 家庭住所；老家

### ### Practice 32

> “She returned to the **family home** for the holiday.”

「她在假期回到**家中的老宅 / 家庭住所**。」

### ### Practice 33

> “The **family home** had been passed down for generations.”

「那座**家族住宅**已傳承了好幾代。」

**\*\*family home = 一個家庭長期居住、共同生活或代代相傳的住所\*\***

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# 17. **\*\*family business — 家族生意；家庭企業\*\***

### Practice 34

> “She joined the **\*\*family business\*\*** after university.”

「她大學畢業後加入了**\*\*家族生意 / 家族企業\*\***。」

### Practice 35

> “The restaurant is a small **\*\*family business\*\***.”

「這間餐廳是一間小型**\*\*家庭經營企業\*\***。」

**\*\*family business = 主要由同一家族擁有、管理或經營的企業\*\***

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# 18. **\*\*family-friendly = 適合家庭 / 兒童的\*\***

A very common compound.

### Practice 36

> “The hotel is very **\*\*family-friendly\*\***.”

「這間酒店非常**\*\*適合家庭入住\*\***。」

### Practice 37

> “They organized a **\*\*family-friendly\*\*** event.”

「他們舉辦了一個**\*\*適合一家大小參加的活動\*\***。」

**\*\*family-friendly = 適合家庭、父母和兒童使用、參與或享受的\*\***

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# 19. **\*\*family-oriented = 重視家庭的；以家庭為中心的\*\***

### Practice 38

> “She is very **family-oriented**.”

「她非常**重視家庭**。」

#### ### Practice 39

> “The company promotes a **family-oriented** culture.”

「公司提倡一種**重視家庭生活的文化**。」

**family-oriented** = 把家庭關係、家庭責任或家庭生活放在重要位置的

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# 20. **family resemblance** — 家族相似之處；家族特徵

#### ### Practice 40

> “You can see the **family resemblance**.”

「你可以看出他們之間有明顯的**家族相似特徵**。」

#### ### Practice 41

> “There is a strong **family resemblance** between the sisters.”

「兩姊妹之間有很明顯的**家族相貌特徵**。」

**family resemblance** = 親屬之間在外貌、聲音或其他特徵上的相似

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# 21. **run in the family** — 家族中常見 / 遺傳

A very useful fixed expression.

#### ### Practice 42

> “Musical ability **runs in the family**.”

「音樂天分在這個**家族中很常見 / 似乎有家族遺傳**。」

#### ### Practice 43

> “High blood pressure **runs in her family**.”

「高血壓在她的\*\*家族中較常見 / 有家族病史\*\*。」

\*\*run in the family = 某種特徵、能力或健康情況在同一家族多名成員中反覆出現\*\*

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# 22. \*\*start a family — 生兒育女；建立家庭\*\*

A major fixed expression.

#### Practice 44

> “They hope to \*\*start a family\*\* soon.”

「他們希望很快\*\*生兒育女 / 建立自己的家庭\*\*。」

#### Practice 45

> “She wants to travel before \*\*starting a family\*\*.”

「她希望在\*\*建立家庭 / 生孩子\*\*之前先去旅行。」

\*\*start a family = 開始擁有自己的子女，建立有孩子的家庭生活\*\*

It does not merely mean getting married.

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# 23. \*\*raise a family — 撫養家庭 / 子女\*\*

#### Practice 46

> “They \*\*raised a family\*\* in a small town.”

「他們在一個小鎮\*\*養育子女、建立家庭生活\*\*。」

#### Practice 47

> “It can be expensive to \*\*raise a family\*\* in a large city.”

「在大城市\*\*養育一家人 / 撫養子女\*\*可能很昂貴。」

\*\*raise a family = 撫養子女並照顧整個家庭成長\*\*

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# 24. \*\*family man / family woman ( 重視家庭的人 ) — 顧家的人\*\*

### Practice 48

> “He is very much a \*\*family man\*\*.”

「他是一個很\*\*顧家、重視家庭的人\*\*。」

### Practice 49

> “She is deeply \*\*family-oriented\*\* and spends most weekends with relatives.”

「她非常\*\*重視家庭\*\*，大部分週末都跟親人一起。」

\*\*family man = 把家人和家庭生活放在很重要位置的男性\*\*

\*\*Family-oriented\*\* is broader and gender-neutral.

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# 25. \*\*familial = relating to family ( 家族 / 家庭的 ) — 家庭的；家族性的\*\*

The main true adjective derived from \*\*family\*\*.

### Practice 50

> “They have strong \*\*familial\*\* ties.”

「他們有很強的\*\*家族 / 親屬聯繫\*\*。」

### Practice 51

> “The condition may show \*\*familial\*\* patterns.”

「這種情況可能呈現\*\*家族性的模式\*\*。」

\*\*familial = 與家人、親屬關係或家族傳承有關的\*\*

It is more formal than simply using \*\*family\*\* as a modifier.

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# 26. \*\*familial = occurring within families / inherited ( 醫療 / 研究 ) — 家族性的\*\*

A common scientific/medical use.

### ### Practice 52

> “Researchers found a **familial** pattern of the disease.”

「研究人員發現這種疾病具有**家族性模式**。」

### ### Practice 53

> “There may be a **familial** tendency toward the condition.”

「這種情況可能存在**家族性傾向**。」

**familial** = 在同一家族成員中較常出現，可能與遺傳或共同家庭因素有關

Important:

**familial** does not automatically mean **genetic**. Shared environment can also matter.

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## Important distinction: **family vs relatives**

### **family**

can mean the whole group as one unit:

> “My family is very close.”

### **relatives**

means the individual people related to you.

> “Many of my relatives live abroad.”

So:

**family** = 家庭 / 家族作為整體

**relatives** = 親戚 / 親屬個人

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## Important distinction: **family vs household**

### **family**

is based mainly on kinship/close family relationships.

### \*\*household\*\*

means:

> the people living together in one home.

A household can include:

- \* family members
- \* roommates
- \* other non-relatives

And members of one family may live in several households.

So the terms are not interchangeable.

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## Important distinction: \*\*family vs home\*\*

### \*\*family\*\*

= the people/kinship group.

### \*\*home\*\*

= the place one lives, or the sense of belonging connected with it.

> “I miss my family.”

= 我掛念家人。

> “I miss home.”

= 我想家 / 掛念自己的家。

Related, but different.

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## Important distinction: \*\*family vs clan\*\*

### \*\*family\*\*

is the normal broad everyday term.

### \*\*clan\*\*

usually means a larger extended kinship group, sometimes with a shared historical ancestor or traditional identity.

It can also be figurative.

So \*\*clan\*\* is narrower and more culturally marked.

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## Important distinction: \*\*family vs dynasty\*\*

### \*\*family\*\*

can be any kinship group.

### \*\*dynasty\*\*

is a succession of rulers or powerful/influential people from the same family.

> “a royal dynasty”

= 王朝

Therefore a dynasty is a special kind of family lineage, not a synonym for ordinary family.

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## Important distinction: \*\*family vs kind/type\*\*

In technical classification:

> “a family of products”

can mean a group of related products.

But \*\*family\*\* usually suggests stronger structural or historical relatedness than plain:

> kind / type

For example:

> “a language family”

means languages historically related through common ancestry.

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**## Important distinction: \*\*family — relatives vs family — children\*\***

This is a key polysemy distinction.

**### \*\*my family\*\***

can mean:

> my relatives / household.

**### \*\*start a family\*\***

usually means:

> have children.

So:

> “They have a large family.”

may mean they have many children.

Context determines the exact scope.

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**## Important distinction: \*\*family history vs family background\*\***

**### \*\*family history\*\***

can mean:

\* events in the family's past

\* medical conditions occurring in relatives

**### \*\*family background\*\***

usually means:

\* social upbringing

\* family environment

\* circumstances someone grew up in

They overlap but should not be treated as identical.

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## Important distinction: \*\*family name vs first name\*\*

### \*\*family name\*\*

= surname shared/inherited through family

### \*\*first name / given name\*\*

= individual's personal name

For example:

> Chan = family name

> Mei = given name

depending on naming convention.

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## Important distinction: \*\*familial vs familiar\*\*

This is especially important given your previous question.

### \*\*familial\*\*

belongs to the \*\*family\*\* group:

> relating to family or relatives

> “familial relationships”

= 家庭 / 親屬關係

### \*\*familiar\*\*

belongs to a separate modern lexical family:

> known, recognized, or well-known to someone

> “Her voice is familiar.”

= 她的聲音很熟悉。

So:

**\*\*familial ≠ familiar\*\***

They should be curated separately.

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**## Important distinction: \*\*family vs familial\*\***

**### \*\*family\*\***

is often used attributively before another noun:

- > family life
- > family member
- > family business

**### \*\*familial\*\***

is a formal adjective:

- > familial relationships
- > familial patterns

In everyday English, **\*\*family + noun\*\*** is much more common.

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**## Family-extension note**

Following the same curation style, these are especially useful members and constructions of the **\*\*family\*\*** group:

- \* **\*\*family — relatives\*\*** = 家人 / 家族
- \* **\*\*family — household/immediate unit\*\*** = 家庭 / 一家人
- \* **\*\*family — children\*\*** = 子女
- \* **\*\*family — lineage\*\*** = 家族 / 世系
- \* **\*\*family — related group of things\*\*** = 類 / 族 / 系列
- \* **\*\*family — biological taxonomy\*\*** = 科
- \* **\*\*family — figurative close group\*\*** = 像家人一樣的團體
- \* **\*\*family member\*\*** = 家庭 / 家族成員
- \* **\*\*family life\*\*** = 家庭生活

\* \*\*family tree\*\* = 家譜  
 \* \*\*family name\*\* = 姓氏  
 \* \*\*family background\*\* = 家庭背景  
 \* \*\*family home\*\* = 家庭住所 / 老家  
 \* \*\*family business\*\* = 家族企業  
 \* \*\*family-friendly\*\* = 適合家庭的  
 \* \*\*family-oriented\*\* = 重視家庭的  
 \* \*\*family resemblance\*\* = 家族相似特徵  
 \* \*\*run in the family\*\* = 在家族中常見 / 有家族性  
 \* \*\*start a family\*\* = 生兒育女 / 建立家庭  
 \* \*\*raise a family\*\* = 撫養子女 / 一家人  
 \* \*\*familial\*\* = 家庭 / 家族相關的；家族性的

And as agreed, I am **not** including:

> familiar / familiarity / familiarize / unfamiliar

because those belong to a separate learner-facing lexical family.

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## ## Master comparison

| Form / sense                             | MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning |
|------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| -----                                    | -----                                 |
| <b>family — relatives</b>                | 與某人有血緣、婚姻或親屬關係的一群人                    |
| <b>family — household/immediate unit</b> | 由父母、子女及親近家屬組成的家庭單位                    |
| <b>family — children</b>                 | 某人的子女，尤其在談生育或建立家庭時                    |
| <b>family — lineage</b>                  | 從祖先延續至後代的家族世系或血統                      |
| <b>family — extended kin group</b>       | 包括不同世代親屬在內的較大家族群體                     |
| <b>family — related category</b>         | 因來源、結構、功能或特徵相近而歸為一組的事物                |
| <b>family — biology</b>                  | 生物分類中位於 order 與 genus 之間的「科」          |
| <b>family — product group</b>            | 因設計、品牌、功能或平台相近而組成的產品系列                |
| <b>family — figurative group</b>         | 沒有血緣但彼此非常親密、互相支持的一群人                  |
| <b>family member</b>                     | 某個家庭 / 家族中的其中一名親屬                     |
| <b>family life</b>                       | 與家人共同生活、相處及承擔家庭角色的生活部分                |
| <b>family tree</b>                       | 顯示家族成員血緣 / 婚姻關係的圖表                    |
| <b>family name</b>                       | 由家族成員共同使用並傳承的姓氏                       |
| <b>family background</b>                 | 一個人的家庭環境、成長經歷及家族情況                    |
| <b>family home</b>                       | 一個家庭長期共同居住或代代相傳的住所                    |
| <b>family business</b>                   | 主要由同一家族擁有、管理或經營的企業                    |
| <b>family-friendly</b>                   | 適合家庭、父母和兒童使用或參與的                      |
| <b>family-oriented</b>                   | 把家庭關係與家庭生活放在重要位置的                     |
| <b>family resemblance</b>                | 親屬之間在外貌、聲音或其他特徵上的相似                   |
| <b>run in the family</b>                 | 某種特徵、能力或健康情況在同一家族多人中反覆出現              |
| <b>start a family</b>                    | 開始生育子女並建立有孩子的家庭生活                     |

|                                   |                              |  |
|-----------------------------------|------------------------------|--|
| **raise a family**                | 撫養子女並照顧家庭成長                  |  |
| **familial — general**            | 與家人、親屬關係或家庭生活有關的             |  |
| **familial — medical/scientific** | 在同一家族成員中較常出現，可能與遺傳或共同家庭因素有關的 |  |

### For your original sentence

> “She is widely respected in my \*\*family\*\* and even in the neighbourhood.”

The exact meaning is:

**\*\*family = 與說話者有親屬關係的家人 / 家族成員，作為一個群體\*\***

Therefore:

> **\*\*in my family\*\***

= **\*\*「在我的家人 / 家族之中」\*\***

The sentence means that your grandmother's reputation for warmth, patience, and wisdom is not merely your personal opinion. **\*\*Other relatives also respect her.\*\***

Here, **\*\*family\*\*** is therefore the **\*\*kinship-group sense\*\***, not:

> **\*\*start a family\*\***

> = 生兒育女

or:

> **\*\*a language family\*\***

> = 語系

or:

> **\*\*a product family\*\***

> = 產品系列

And, as agreed, **\*\*familiar / familiarity / familiarize\*\*** remain outside this entry as a separate lexical family.